If virtualisation changed the way people work, virtualisation mobility is taking it to another level. With a plethora of mobile devices available and the trend of BYOD (Bring Your Own Device) picking up, the mobile workforce is replacing traditional ways of working. Virtualisation mobility, though a new term in the IT world, is picking up fast. ***Diksha P Gupta*** from ***Open Source For You*** spoke to firms like ***Novell, Citrix*** and ***VMware*** about the trend. Excerpts:

Where is virtualisation technology heading with regard to mobile devices?	The major challenges that come with the BYOD concept are security and effective productivity. Will virtualisation address these in any way?	How are application developers responding to this trend?
What users will eventually care about is a user-friendly device with a good form-factor, which can help them do their work. They will not bother about whether it is getting virtualised or streamed. Enterprises are trying to bring out a framework that would help them to deliver any application on any device. That is where I see virtualisation technology heading to in the mobile space.	Yes. As I said, virtualisation is just about sending the image. The data always resides in your data centre. It gives you an impression that you are working on the data that resides in your machine. But the fact is that the data is hosted at the data centre. It's only the image that is travelling to the end users. So, even if the network gets hacked, it will not affect the security.	Developers are quite positive about virtualisation because now they know that their applications can be taken to any device and any application, courtesy virtualisation. Developers are able to leverage the popularity of various platforms. They are now sure that they can deliver their applications anywhere.
We will need to see a more OS-agnostic approach for virtualisation technologies if they are going to continue to provide value to the mobile workforce. There will be more of an emphasis on native or Web-based (e.g., HTML5) applications that are controlled and managed through a single source or a 'corporate app store'. I believe virtualisation technology will take more of a back seat to the corporate app store as the tools to build these applications mature over the next year or two.	This issue has two aspects to it. The first is that the in-built security features of these devices are not utilised. ZENworks Mobile Management addresses these and other more security compliance needs.The second aspect is addressing the applications. A virtualisation solution can address this. What we see as being more valuable to the end user is a more container approach to the application and the data, allowing for the potential to access both when offline.	We are seeing developers addressing the second aspect by building native applications that provide this application and data-container model, or by embracing more open Web standards like HTML5 or SVG to provide Web-based applications that are capable of being more OS independent.
Nowadays, irrespective of who actually buys or owns the device—the corporation or the user—most employees tend to download personal apps onto these devices. It is fair to assume then that most devices will have both personal and corporate content (apps, data and services). Given that the usage paradigms have changed, IT needs to rethink the security and manageability of mobile devices. IT administrators can now leverage VMware Horizon Mobile to isolate personal content from corporate content and only manage the corporate content on the device.	It seems that the flexibility that end users desire is in direct conflict to the security and governance that corporate IT requires. VMware Horizon Workspace gives users a single interface where they can access the apps they need, securely delivered to them on the devices they want to use.	If corporate IT is unable to supply a particular application on their device of choice, employees turn to external consumer solutions, which impacts security and governance. This new mobile paradigm is forcing IT leaders to face a daunting set of challenges. Not only must they provide multiple applications on multiple devices, but they must also ensure complete security and high availability.